In light of the above, he gave a clear and focused goal: 'to disrupt, dismantle and defeat al-Qaeda in Pakistan and Afghanistan, and to prevent their return to either country in the future.' In addition to the military action, the Af-Pak Policy ensured massive injections of cash, projects and experts for economic and social development in Pakistan and Afghanistan (Common Ground News, 2009).

Pakistan had two concerns over the policy: (1) Pakistan objected to comparing it with Afghanistan. The Prime Minister said, 'Pakistan is a nuclear state with strong institutions. There is a free media and judiciary in Pakistan. Therefore Pakistan should not be viewed on the same lines as Afghanistan' (*The Daily Times*, 2009). (2) Pakistan wanted the Af-Pak authors to take the Pak-India rivalry into consideration, which was essential to enable Pakistan to switch its concentration from the Eastern border with India to FATA, Swat and the Western border with Afghanistan (*The Daily Times*, 2009).

Despite these severe reservations, the Pakistan Army and the government of Pakistan managed to resolve it and responded positively. It carried out unprecedented military operation against the local Taliban in Swat and later on in Waziristan.

However, the image of the US remained overwhelmingly negative in Pakistan, according to the 2010 Global Attitudes Project report released by the PEW Research Centre. About six in ten Pakistanis – 59 per cent – viewed the US as Pakistan's enemy, decreasing only slightly from the 64 per cent reported in 2009 (*The Daily Times*, 2010). However, in the wake of the killing of Osama bin Laden by the US marines at Abbottabad and subsequent strong rumours that the US was bent upon taking out Pakistan's nuclear arsenal, the anti-US sentiments touched new heights in Pakistan. The US-Pak relations nosedived further. In May 2011, Mr Husain Haqqani, former Ambassador of Pakistan to the US was startled to learn during a lecture at the National Defence University, Islamabad, that the majority of the audience, who were mostly highly educated and well-placed people, perceived the US as the 'Enemy number One of Pakistan'. Surprisingly, the US managed to clinch this negative top-slot from India, which is otherwise considered the erstwhile enemy of Pakistan (*The Nation* 2011).

Three reasons seemed to have spurred anti-US sentiments and also given birth to conspiracy theories galore. The first reason was that most